

Software That Proves It, Every Morning

A Canadian payment firm holding somebody else's money has owed a daily proof since 8 September 2025. At almost every firm that owes it, the work is done by hand in a spreadsheet. 4orm Finance performs that proof, keeps it, and produces it in the form an examiner asks for. This document sets out what gets built and why it is built in that order.

9	5	2	0
LAYERS IN THE BUILD	SCREENS A PERSON OPENS	DATES ON EVERY RECORD	WAYS TO CHANGE A STORED RECORD

DISCLOSURE TIER Open	Who reads it. Any member of the data room, a prospective investor at first contact, a channel partner being sized up. No signature is needed to read it. What it says. What the software does, what it refuses to do, and how a reader can test the refusal without taking our word for it. What it holds back. How the evidence store is built. An application covering that mechanism is in preparation with counsel. Every place it would appear is marked on the page.
--------------------------------	--

We never touch the money.

4orm Finance is not a bank and holds no customer funds. It never signs a filing on a customer's behalf and it never decides anything for the customer. The duty stays with the firm that holds the money, and so does the signature. What we sell is the proof the law asks to see.

1 This document in four parts, read in this order



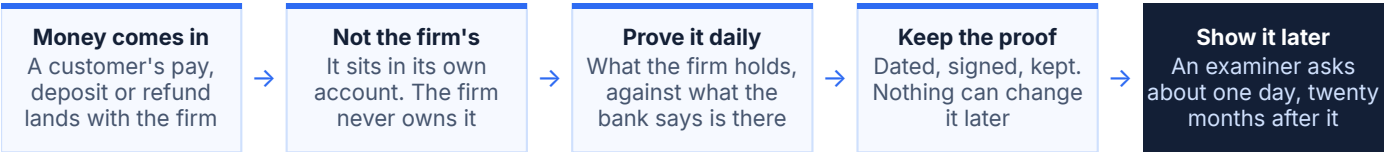
A reader who stops at the end of part three understands what is being built and why it is hard. Part four is for a reader deciding whether the order of work is the right one.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

- Architecture Pack.** Architecture Pack, 4orm Finance, 5 August 2026, sections 1 to 28
- Duty start date.** The retail payment activities regime commenced for Canadian payment service providers on 8 September 2025

The duty behind the software

The duty itself is old and well understood. A lawyer holding a house deposit has always had to account for it. Only the industry is new.



Steps one to three are the duty every firm already knows about. Steps four and five are where it goes wrong, because both are about a day that has already gone. Everything else in this document is a choice about how to make those two hold up in front of somebody who has every reason to doubt us.

2 The words in this document, and what each one means

Trust account	A bank account holding money that belongs to somebody else. A lawyer holding your house deposit is the everyday example.
Payment company	A business that holds or moves money for other people without being a bank. Payroll firms, money transfer apps and gift card companies. These are our first customers.
Safeguarding	Keeping customer money apart from the company's own money, and being able to prove it.
Examiner	The person from the regulator who asks to see the records, usually about a date in the past.
Evidence store	The place the daily proof is kept. Records go in, get dated, and are never changed.
Reconciliation	Checking two lists against each other. What a company says it holds for customers, against what the bank says is in the account.
Independent review	An outside firm checking the records. The first one falls due in September 2028 and it looks back three years.
Penalty ceiling	The largest fine a regulator can hand out for one breach. Here it is one million dollars for a serious one and ten million for a very serious one.
CVER	Cryptographically verifiable evidence retrieval. A record of what was held, when, and who confirmed it, that can be proven later to have gone unaltered.

Every engineering word beyond this list is spelled out at the foot of the page that uses it.

Nothing later in this document uses a special word that is not defined where a reader meets it. That is a rule for the whole set, and it holds at every tier.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 1 and 2, the duty in five steps and the word list

Three things proof software does that ordinary software does not

Ordinary business software is judged by what it shows a user today. This one is judged by a stranger, about a day that has already gone, under a rule that may since have changed. Those three differences set every choice in the rest of this document.

1

Remember, rather than store

Ordinary software keeps what is true now and writes over the rest. This one keeps each state it has held, with who put it there and when, because the question it gets asked is always about a day that has already gone.

2

Know which rule applied

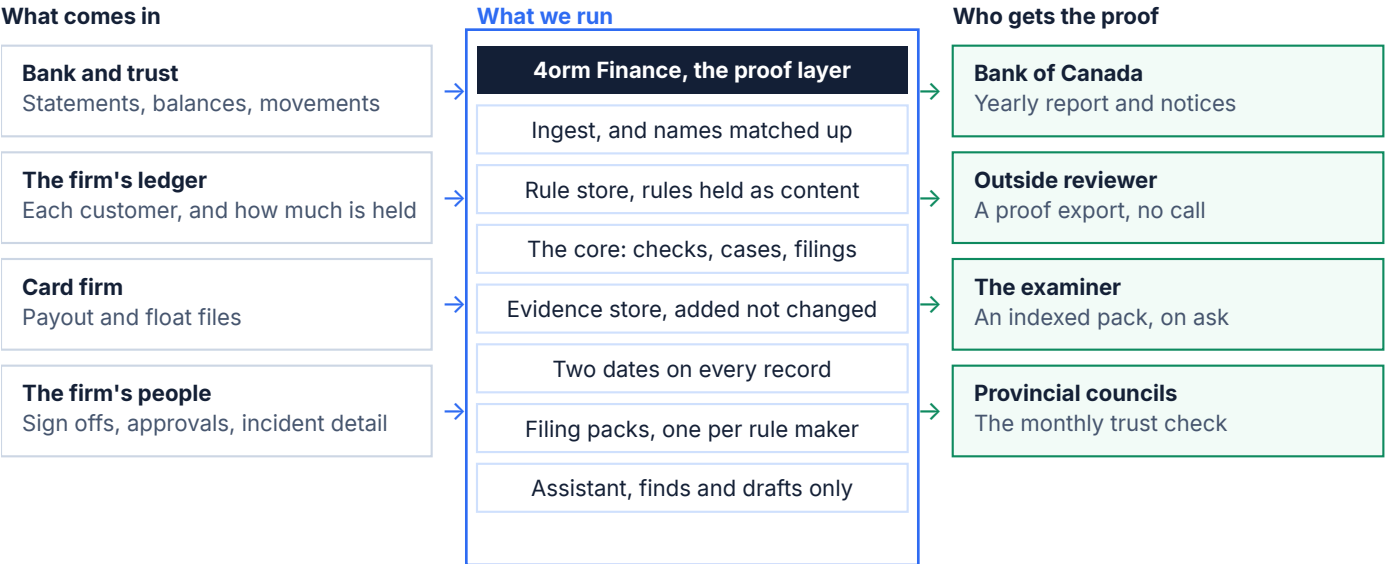
Ordinary software writes the rules of the day into the code of the day. This one holds them as dated content, so a duty done in March 2026 is shown under the rule as it stood in March 2026.

3

Be believed by a stranger

Ordinary software is trusted because the customer trusts it. This one has to be trusted by an examiner and a reviewer who have no tie to us and every reason to doubt.

3 What comes in, what we run, who gets the proof



Three of those four readers have no contract with us and no reason to be kind.

That is the design constraint. A system built to satisfy the customer in front of you is a different system from one built to satisfy the stranger who arrives twenty months later.

Nine layers, and the two that carry the position

Screens

Five of them. Today, Money, Proof, Filings, Exam pack

The core

Checks, cases and sign offs

Assistant

Finds and drafts. Never decides

Rule store

Canada's rules, held as dated content

Filing packs

One closed form per rule maker

Evidence store

Added to, never changed

Two dates

What we knew, and what applied

Ingest

Bank, custodian and trust feeds. Names matched, repeats dropped

Platform

Customers kept apart at the row and at the key. Data in Canada

The two inside the dashed rule are never handed to a build partner. The whole position rests on them.

Read the drawing from the bottom. Data enters at the platform and rises. Proof leaves from the screens at the top. Everything above the platform is content, a setting, or a list of fields. The core knows about checks, papers with a signer, and filings. It does not know what a payment firm is, which is what lets one build carry a second regulator.

4 What each layer name means

Layer	
The core	The one build that does the work: the compare, the sums and the test. It reads and runs. It is not code that gets rewritten for each new duty.
Rule store	Canada's rules held as dated content, so a rule change is a piece of writing rather than new code. Engineers would call it an obligation library.
Evidence store	Where finished records are kept. Written once, never altered.
Platform	The bottom layer. Where the data sits, who may reach it, and how it is brought back after a failure.
Screens	The five pages a person looks at. They ask for records and never make one.
Assistant	The part that searches and drafts inside one customer. It never writes proof.
Filing pack	The part that turns our records into the exact form one rule maker accepts.

The core does not know what a payment firm is. It knows about checks, papers with a signer, and filings. Keeping it that ignorant is what lets one build carry a provincial trust duty without a second build underneath it.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Section 5, the nine layers

Five screens, and what each one replaces today

Screen	What it answers	What it replaces today
Today	Whether anything is late	A wall calendar, a reminder in somebody's phone, and hoping
Money	Whether yesterday balanced	A spreadsheet with a tab for each day, built by somebody who has since left
Proof	Where the paper is	Eleven folders on a shared drive and an email trail
Filings	Whether the report is ready	Three weeks in March rebuilding the year from memory
Exam pack	What an examiner gets	A person with another job, assembling a box for an examiner

Legend. None of these five is new work. Each one is done today, by hand, by a person who has another job as well. Five screens is a promise rather than a starting point: it is the reason one build can carry a second set of rules.

5 The same five screens carrying a completely different rule maker

Screen	A payment firm, daily, to the Bank of Canada	A property firm, monthly, to a provincial council
Money	Customer balances against the safeguarding account, with the shortfall test	Client records against the trust account, with a list of what is held for each client
Proof	Plan, test results, legal view on the account and incident files	Signed checks, a note on each client record, and the broker sign off on each one
Filings	The 31 March report to the Bank of Canada, filled in from the record	What the provincial council asks for on an inspection, built the same way
Exam pack	The pack an examiner asks for, cut by date range and by duty	The pack a practice review asks for, cut in exactly the same way

Legend. Two laws, two clocks, two rule makers, one set of five screens. The writing at the top changes. The middle and the foot of the record stay the same.

Bank of Canada Daily. Fourteen separate duties sit under one law.	A provincial council Monthly. One trust check runs for each brokerage.
---	--

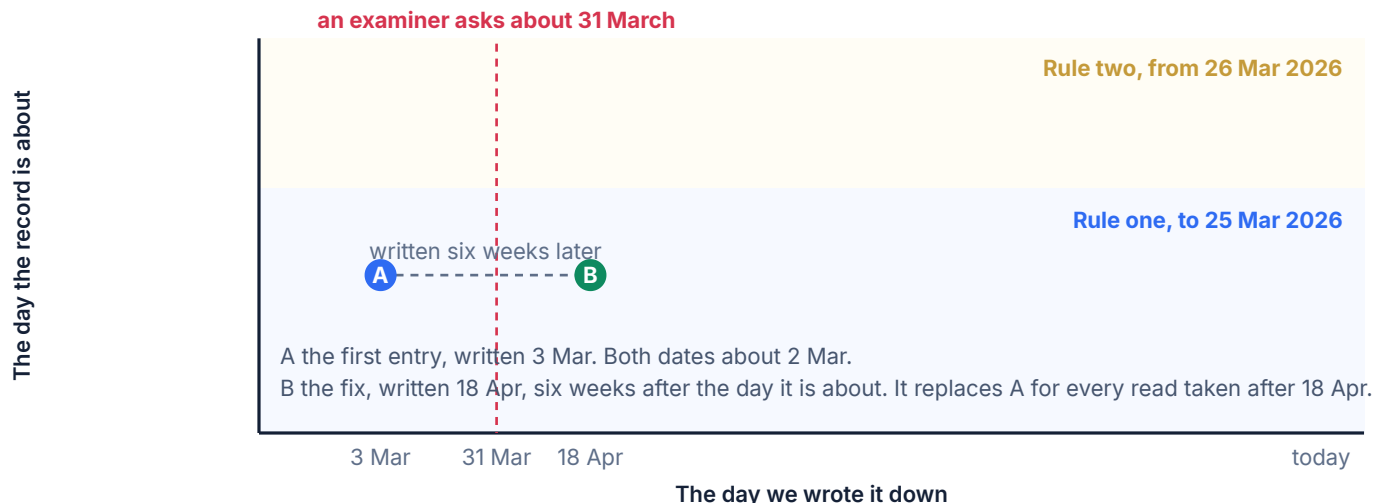
One rule store, and one build underneath both

Written as content, not coded · two dates on every record · added to, never changed

Today is anything late	Money did it balance	Proof where is the paper	Filings is the report ready	Exam pack what an examiner gets
---------------------------	-------------------------	-----------------------------	--------------------------------	------------------------------------

Two dates on every record, and why one is not enough

An examiner in November 2027 is not asking what the balance is now. She is asking what the record said on 31 March 2026, before a fix landed and before the person who typed it left.



With one date

The system answers with today's version of the truth. It cannot say what it held on 31 March, or which rule it was using at the time.

With two dates

Read the plane up the dashed line and it hands back A, under rule one, with the signer and the time attached. The later fix does not move that answer.

A line answers where a value stands now. A plane answers what we held on a given day, under the rule in force that day. Every question this business gets asked is one point on that plane. Engineers call it a bitemporal model, which just means two dates. It is not part of the application, and it is drawn here in full.

6 The two questions almost no system can answer

1 What did you know on the day?

A system that keeps only what is true now can answer today's truth and nothing else. The fix that landed in April has already written over the answer the examiner is asking for.

2 What did the rule say on the day?

The second date, and the one everybody forgets. The yearly form changes each year. A record that cannot name the version it was worked under invites a second letter.

This is the layer that cannot be added in year two.

The rule versions that applied to past choices were never kept, so they cannot be worked out from anything, at any price. A week of work at the start and a year of work later are a thing done and a thing that can no longer be done at all.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 9 and 10, the two questions and the two dates

One morning, step by step

Seven steps, and no person until step six. The order is the point, and the clock is a column of its own. Blue is the software working with nobody there. Green is the one step where a named person signs.

1	Feeds Files land	02:00	Statements, the customer ledger and payout files arrive
2	Ingest Files checked	02:10	Names matched, repeats dropped, fields checked
3	Rule store Rule picked	06:00	Which duty applies, and which version was in force that day
4	The core Money compared	06:05	The gap is worked out and every unexplained item is listed
5	Evidence store Result stored	06:06	Result, inputs, rule version and signer written once
6	Screens A person signs	09:14	A named person reads the list of gaps and signs
7	Filing Report filled in	31 Mar	The same record becomes a filled in box on the yearly report

The software does the work. The person carries the authority.

Both are written down as they happen, rather than put back together afterwards. A record made on the morning it happened is worth something to an examiner. A record built in March out of memory is not.

7 Three things that stay true of that morning

1 Safe to run twice

The same file read twice makes one record, not two, so a month can be loaded again without fear of double counting.

2 Safe to run again

When a rule changes, the days it touches are worked out again and the difference is shown, because a silent restatement looks the same as a cover up.

3 Runs with nobody there

A record that needs a person present depends on somebody having had a good week. The person gives the signature and never the labour.

Steps one to five run with nobody there.

The person shows up once, at step six, to read the list of unexplained items and sign. A sign off is only proof if a person with the right to sign gave it, at a time, and that is the one thing software must never do on their behalf.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 10 and 16, the morning and what holds true

What the system does when it does not know

Every row below is a choice about the moment a step cannot finish. The honest answer is nearly always to stop and say so, because a made up carry on cannot be explained to an examiner later.

Step	The failure	What the system does
1 Feeds	A file does not turn up, or turns up cut short	Raises a missing feed alert against the duty, not into a queue. Silence is never taken for success
2 Ingest	A field will not read, or a name cannot be matched	Fails the file loudly and holds it. Never fills a blank, never half loads, never guesses a name
3 Rule store	No duty version covers the day being worked	Stops, and asks the person who owns the rules. Working under a guessed rule is worse than not working
4 The core	The gap is over the limit, or the shortfall test fails	Makes the result anyway, flagged, with the list attached. A failing check is still a record
5 Evidence store	The write cannot finish	The whole step fails and runs again. There is no half write, because half a record breaks the chain
6 Screens	Nobody signs by the cut off	The duty goes late and is escalated. The record shows unsigned, which is itself the proof
7 Filing	The rule maker's portal turns the payload down	Keeps the refusal as a record, tries again on a clock, and never reshapes the payload to make it pass

Legend. Every row is a choice about what the system does when it does not know. The honest answer is nearly always to stop and say so, because a made up carry on cannot be explained later.

8 How long each thing is kept, run by the system rather than written as a policy

Duty	Kept for	What the clock has to do
Money records	As the rule says, from the date of the record	Start on the record date, not the date it was loaded, because a back dated fix does not restart the span it fixes
Plans and reviews	At least through the next outside review	Live through a rule change. A replaced plan version is still the version that applied when it applied
Open banking proof	Five years	Keep sign off paperwork, consent records and incident write ups on a clock of their own
Read events	As long as the records they touch	A read log that runs out before its records is worse than no log, because it implies a fullness it does not have

Legend. Keeping clocks are where rule software usually fails without anybody noticing. Deleting on time is easy. Proving that nothing went early, and that what went was meant to go, is the part that needs the chain.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 17 and 18, the failure paths and the keeping clocks

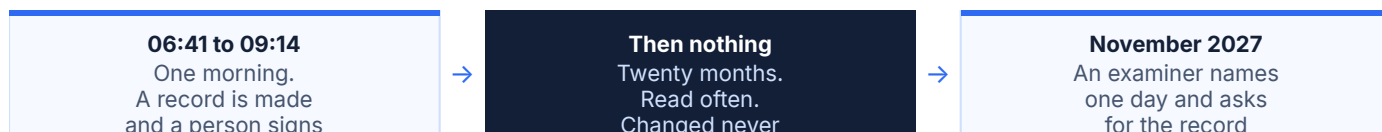
Four things ruled out, on purpose and for good

A design is easier to trust when it is written down as a list of refusals. Each line on the left is a thing this system will not do, in any release, for any customer. Each line on the right is what it does instead.

Never ships	Ships instead
A way to change or delete a stored record, in any setting, for any reason, support included	Records locked to each other, so tampering shows rather than being merely frowned on
A script that rewrites old rows. Changes to the shape of the data add, they never revise	A replacement linked as data, so the story of a fix is itself part of the record
A fix that wipes the record it replaces	Fixes sit beside the old record, which stays readable
An admin override, however carefully guarded	A log of who read what on every read, including reads by us and reads by the founder

Legend. An override exists or it does not, and one is enough. These four are the reason a watched buyer can be handed a running system rather than a policy document.

9 The gap that is the whole business



A record is made in three minutes on a Tuesday morning and asked for twenty months later by somebody who was not there. Everything in the middle panel is a choice about what cannot happen. The honest answer, nearly every time, is nothing at all.

10 The one step test, which a reader can run themselves

Export a month. Export the same month again a year later. Compare the two.

The same bytes, or the store is not add only, whatever the paperwork says. That comparison is built as an automatic check inside the first release, rather than promised in a security form. It is the whole control, and it is the one thing worth asking every vendor in this category to demonstrate.

HELD BACK ON THIS PAGE · PATENT APPLICATION IN PREPARATION

How the store is built so that comparison passes is not described here. That covers how a record is fingerprinted from its own content, how each record is locked to the one before it, how a correction is admitted without breaking that lock, and how two exports a year apart are made to land on identical bytes. **An application covering this mechanism is in preparation with counsel.** The detail is released to a named build partner or a customer's security reviewer on a countersigned NDA, in document 03.2.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 7, 12 and 14, the refusals and the one step test

The eight questions a watched buyer asks, and the answer each one needs

Each of these has to be answerable in the first sales call rather than the third. A reviewer who is handed a document rather than a running system treats a pause here as a finding.

The question	The answer that has to already be true	Layer
Where does our data live?	Canada, written into the contract, with the region named and the list of suppliers published	Platform
Can your staff see our records?	Only with a logged read attached. Reads by us are logged the way reads by the customer are, and nobody holds a standing login to live data	Platform
Can a record be changed after the fact?	There is no way to change and no way to delete in the code. Fixes replace rather than write over, and the replaced record stays readable	Evidence store
Prove that to our outside reviewer.	Two exports of the same month, taken a year apart, compared byte for byte	Evidence store
What happens when the rule changes?	A signed release by the person who owns the rules, with the past run again and the difference shown rather than restated	Rule store
Does your assistant read our data?	One customer at a time, never across customers, each answer tied to a record and every use logged as an event	Assistant
Who are your subcontractors?	Named in the agreement and disclosed, with notice before any change	Platform
What if you are bought, or fail?	Export in every view, in a form the customer can read without us, and a copy of the rule store content lodged with a third party	Screens

Legend. The eight come up in roughly this order, and a pause on any one of them costs the same as a wrong answer.

11 What a reviewer does with them



Every answer above is a thing already built, not a thing promised.

A watched buyer can ask for the proof of any one of the eight in the first call. That is the whole reason the layers nobody can see are built first.

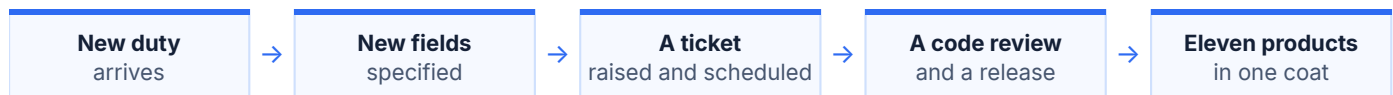
SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Section 22, the eight security review questions

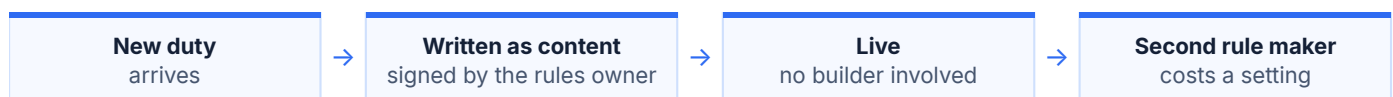
Why one build can carry a second rule maker

Fourteen duties, four rule makers, three shapes. A new duty is a set of fields, a set of steps and a set of links, written by the person who owns the rules and released as content. If any part of that needs a code release, the job is a product rather than a setting, and the money behind everything downstream changes with it.

How it must not work.



How it does work.



12 Fourteen duties, three shapes, one build

By part ■ ■ **Safeguard 2** ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ **Comply 11** ■ **Trust 1**

By shape ■ ■ ■ **Check 3** ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ **Paper 7** ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ **Filing 4**

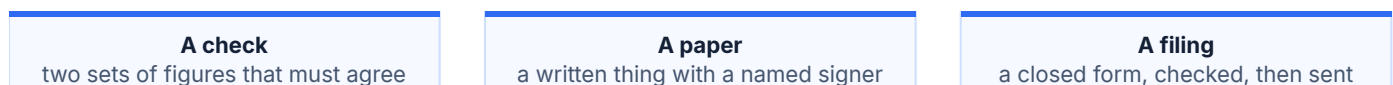
The same fourteen duties counted twice. Every mark stands for one duty. A check is two sets of figures that have to agree, with a gap, a limit and a signature. A paper is a written thing with a version, an owner and a person who approved it on a date. A filing is a form in the shape the rule maker sets, checked before it goes and kept with its receipt. Not one of the four rule makers needs a shape the core does not already have.

13 Four rule makers, and the same three shapes under all of them



Each duty written as content, and read by one core

The writing at the top changes with every rule maker. Nothing below it does.



If the eleventh job needs code, the whole idea has failed.

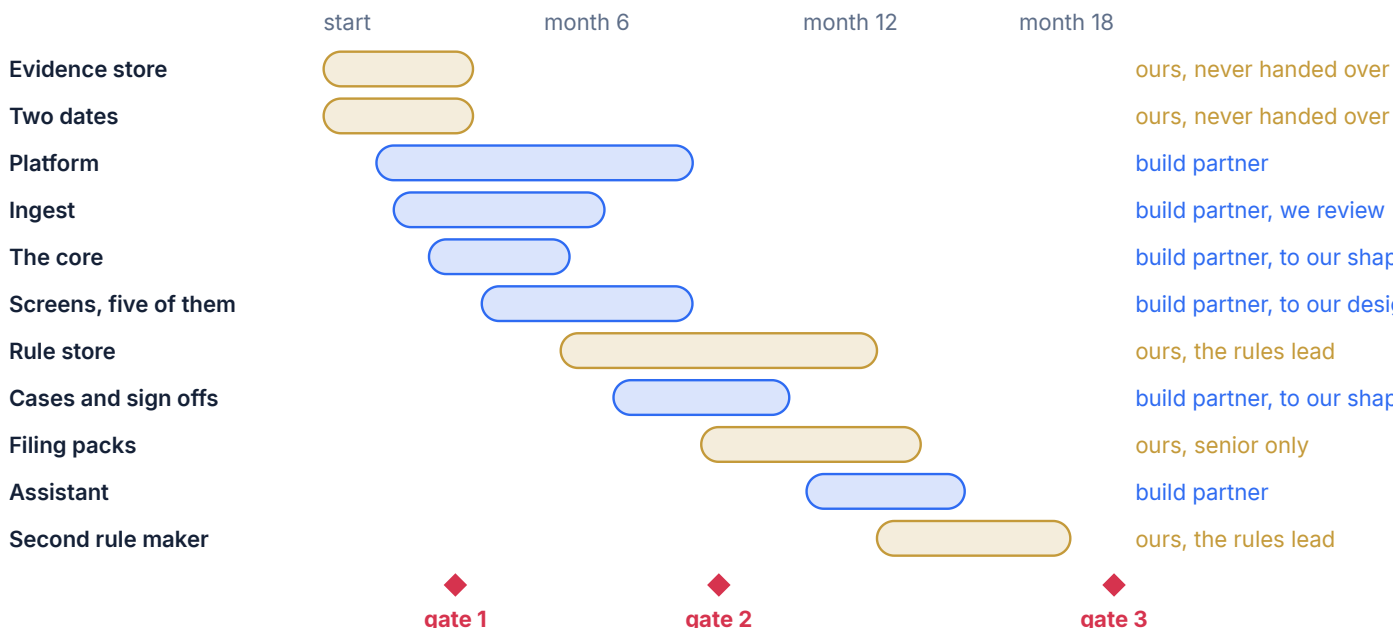
That one sentence is the test behind every choice in this document. It is why the five screens are fixed at five, and why the rules are held as content rather than written into the build.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 19 and 20, the eleventh job and the worked example

Build order. The two hardest layers start first and finish first

That is the opposite of the usual order, in which the screens ship first and the parts nobody can see are promised for a release that later gets squeezed.



Gold is ours and never handed over. Blue is the build partner, working to shapes we set. Speer Technologies is the build partner. Each gate releases the next stage of work against something being true rather than against a date: at gate one, a first release with early customers signing a real check every morning; at gate two, the full duty set shipped, with paying customers counted rather than forecast; at gate three, the exam pack and a second rule maker running on the same build, with no fork in the code.

1 Gate 1 · month 3

A first release, with early customers signing a real check every morning. The evidence store and the two dates are finished before this gate, not after it.

2 Gate 2 · month 9

The full duty set shipped, with paying customers counted rather than forecast.

3 Gate 3 · month 18

The exam pack, and a second rule maker running on the same build with no fork in the code. This is the gate that tests the whole commercial case.

Read the plan by what finishes first, not by what starts first.

The evidence store and the two dates are the two layers a customer never sees, and the two that cannot be added afterwards at any price. Both are done before the first screen is drawn. The screens are held to a fixed set of five, so the usual squeeze at the end has nothing left to take.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 25 and 27, the split of the build and the plan

What this document does not prove

A document that only argues one way is worth less than one that says where it stops. Four things a reader should hold against everything above.

It describes a build, not a running system	The dates, the layers and the refusals set out here are a plan and a set of commitments. What exists today is the design, the duty analysis and the build agreement. A reader should ask what is running before treating any of it as shipped.
The hardest claim is the one that cannot be demonstrated yet	Two exports of the same month, taken a year apart, is a test that by its nature needs a year of records behind it. Until then it is an automatic check inside the build and a commitment on this page, and a reader is entitled to say so.
The second rule maker is a claim, not a fact	One build carrying a provincial trust duty alongside the federal one is the whole commercial case, and it is tested at gate three rather than proven today. The design is written so the test can be run on purpose rather than waiting for a customer to run it for us.
Part of the mechanism is held back	The page marked on this document's seventh page withholds how the evidence store is built, pending an application in preparation with counsel. A reader in diligence gets it on a countersigned NDA. A reader who wants it now should ask.

What we do, in one line.

4orm Finance performs, keeps and produces the daily proof a regulated business owes when it holds somebody else's money.

Read more

03.2 Technical Architecture takes every drawing in this document one level deeper, for a build partner and for a customer's security reviewer. It is released on a countersigned mutual NDA. Ask for it by name.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Architecture Pack, 4orm Finance, 5 August 2026, the source for every drawing in this document

Disclosure control. Document 03.0, internal, which sets what this tier may and may not say